



Performance review phrases for leadership: 24 examples by rating and by skill (2026)

Last checked 5 October 2026. Fill in the [BRACKETS] with your own facts.

Exceeds what the role needs

Gives people clear goals and checks in regularly: for example, [THE TEAM GOAL].

Gives feedback that is specific and timely: for example, [THE OCCASION].

Holds regular one-to-ones that people value: for example, [WHAT TEAM MEMBERS SAID].

Deals with problems in the team early and directly: for example, [THE CASE].

Meets what the role needs

Sets goals with the team and reviews them: [THE GOALS].

Holds one-to-ones as planned: [HOW OFTEN].

Is approachable: team members bring problems to them: for example, [THE CASE].

Recognises good work in the team: for example, [THE CASE].

Below what the role needs

One-to-ones have been cancelled or skipped: [NUMBER] times in [PERIOD].

Feedback to team members has come late or not at all: for example, [THE CASE].

Team members have said they are unsure what is expected of them: for example, [WHAT WAS SAID].

Difficult conversations have been put off: for example, [THE MATTER].

Delegating and developing others

Exceeds

Hands over tasks with a clear goal and a date, then lets people do them: for example, [TASK AND WHO TOOK IT].

Meets

Gives work to the right people and checks progress at agreed points: for example, [PROJECT].

Below

Keeps tasks that others could do, which leaves less time for planning: for example, [TASK]. I would like to agree what to hand over.

Exceeds

Helped [NAME] take on [NEW RESPONSIBILITY] by [WHAT THEY DID TO SUPPORT THEM].

Decisions and direction

Exceeds

Makes decisions on time and explains the reasons to the team: for example, [DECISION AND HOW IT WAS EXPLAINED].

Meets

Decides when needed and tells the team what was decided: for example, [DECISION].

Below

Decisions have sometimes come late, and the team waited for direction: for example, [DECISION AND THE DELAY].

Below

Changes in direction were not always explained, so the team was unsure why: for example, [CHANGE AND WHEN].

Handling pressure and conflict

Exceeds

Stays clear about priorities when the workload rises, and tells the team what can wait: for example, [BUSY PERIOD].

Meets

Speaks to both sides when two team members disagree and agrees the next step: for example, [THE CASE].

Below

Under pressure, instructions to the team have changed several times in a day: for example, [DATES AND WHAT CHANGED].

Exceeds

Raised a risk to senior managers early, with options attached: for example, [THE RISK AND THE OPTIONS].

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